

tem with multiple partitions, you would need to create multiple images. However, all these images can be stored as a single WIM file, since the WIM file format supports multiple images per file. The WIM file format also supports single-instance storage, so duplicate files (even from different images) are automatically removed. Thanks to this and compression, WIM images are smaller than images created by other tools. But the compression and other processing takes some CPU time while creating the images. The trade-off is thus of smaller size and thus less bandwidth consumption over a network versus worth the extra CPU cycles spent on creation.

Finally, you can also mount a WIM file as a file system, which can be then read and modified as it works like a normal removable drive.

1.4.10. Vista Is Language-neutral

Many companies are required to support more than one language for their OS deployment. This was quite the chore under Windows XP, where multiple language support requires addition of an English Multilanguage User Interface with the required language packs. Windows Vista, though, is language-neutral. Language packs act as components to the base image and can be added and removed in accordance with an organisation's requirements. The servicing of the Vista core is also language-agnostic, and only security updates would generally be required to serve Vista installs of different languages. Configuration of the deployment is also language-neutral and one `unattend.xml` can be used for all languages that the organisation finds necessary to support.

Windows XP supports different languages in two ways. You can either deploy localised versions of Windows XP, requiring a different image for each language, or you can deploy an English Multilanguage User Interface (MUI) version with added language packs.